

Table XX. Covid-19 incidence rates and state prime ministers' statements favoring (de)centralized decision-making

	(1)	(2)
ln(state-level incidence rate)	1.983*** (0.425)	1.985*** (0.438)
ln(state-level vaccination rate)		0.806 (0.117)
State's general attitude towards federalism (1 = strong preference for decentralization, ... , 4 = strong preference for centralization)	0.850 (0.164)	0.826 (0.161)
State's financial strength (mean 94, SD 17)	0.990 (0.012)	0.989 (0.012)
State's share of the manufacturing sector in gross value added	0.161 (0.293)	0.136 (0.250)
Linear time trend	Yes	Yes
Dummies for East German states / Berlin	Yes	Yes

Notes: Each column reports exponentiated coefficients from a separate ordered logit regression. Dependent variable is the 4-point pandemic policy index (PPI). Higher values indicate a stronger expressed desire for centralized decision-making. Coefficients are expressed as changes in the odds ratio of giving a statement Y_j that falls into a higher vs a lower category j , i.e., $P(Y \leq j)/P(Y > j)$. All regressions control for ln(federal level incidence rate) and column (5) additionally controls for ln(federal level vaccination rate) and a dummy for the pre-vaccination period. Column (5) additionally controls for a dummy for the pre-vaccination period. State-level controls include states' general stances towards federalism, share of the manufacturing sector in gross value added, and financial strength ("Finanzkraftmesszahl").

*** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.10$